



SUPERIOR COURT OF SAN MATEO COUNTY

Probate - Probate

Courtroom 2C

Hearing Date: 09/08/2026 - 09:00 AM

08/21/2026

11:41 AM

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Judge: Novak, Lisa A.

Clerk: Ortega, Alexandrina

Reporter: Conde, Wendy

**IN THE SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA IN AND FOR THE COUNTY
OF SAN MATEO**

Probate

Department 13

Courtroom 2C

Hon. Lisa A. Novak

September 8, 2026 - 9:00 AM

If an appearance by Zoom is allowed, parties must appear through Zoom Video.

Zoom Audio is only to be used if Zoom Video is unavailable.

Please check in with the clerk by 8:45 AM.

Zoom Video/Audio Information	Zoom Phone-Audio Only Information Please Note: You must join by dialing in from a telephone; credentials will not work from a tablet or PC
<u>Click on this link to join the Zoom meeting (no meeting ID or passcode required):</u> Meeting ID: 161 920 9458 PASSWORD: 696850	Phone number: 1 (669) 254-5252 Meeting ID: 161 920 9458 PASSWORD: 696850

If a tentative ruling contains "APPEARANCE ORDERED", failure to appear may cause the Petition to be denied or Opposition stricken. Remote appearance is allowed BUT FOR all matters in which SIJF are sought, and where the Court has ordered an In Person appearance. Failure to appear may result in sanctions.

If a tentative ruling contains "APPEARANCE OPTIONAL", failure to appear is a waiver of oral argument and the Court may issue orders differing from the tentative ruling. Zoom is allowed for all optional appearances.

If a tentative ruling contains "NO APPEARANCE", an appearance is not required, as the matter has been pre-approved, continued, or dropped, as described.

If you wish to appear in response to the tentative ruling or in opposition to a petition, you must notify the probate clerk at dept13@sanmateocourt.org and all other parties of the intent to appear. All notifications must be completed no later than 4:00 p.m. on the court day immediately preceding the day of the hearing.



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21-PRO-00207	THE TRUST OF ROSETTA MCGEE	APPLICATION, MOTION AND NOTICE OF MOTION TO DETERMINE ATTORNEYS' FEE AWARD TO PETITIONERS PURSUANT TO JUDGMENT ENTERED ??????R 3, 2022- Continued from 07/13/26 As to RESPONDENT, Mary McBean, As to Why the Motion Should Not be Granted
Line 1, 2	Petitioner: BALLARD, ROBERT C. (EISENBERG, MARTIN M.) Petitioner: GREEN, DOROTHY L. (EISENBERG, MARTIN M.) Petitioner: MCGEE, JOSEPH C. (EISENBERG, MARTIN M.) Respondent: McBean, Mary (Pro Se) Decedent: MCGEE, ROSETTA Participant: MCGEE, JAMES COREY	Motion hearings Order to Show Cause Hearing
Tentative Ruling: APPEARANCE OPTIONAL Motion and Order to Show Cause are CONTINUED to <u>November 30, 2026 at 9:00</u> am for service on Ms. Bean to be completed.		



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21-PRO-00795	Conservatorship of Isabel Alleene Miranda	
Line 3	Proposed Conservatee: Miranda, Isabel Alleene (FRIEDMAN, SHERRIE S.) Petitioner: Miranda, Laurel B. (Pro Se) Petitioner: Miranda, Steven R. (Pro Se) Proposed Conservator: Miranda, Laurel B. (Pro Se) Proposed Conservator: Miranda, Robert F. Proposed Conservator: Miranda, Steven R. (Pro Se) Conservatee: Miranda, Isabel Alleene (FRIEDMAN, SHERRIE S.) Conservator: Miranda, Laurel B. (Pro Se) Conservator: Miranda, Robert F. Conservator: Miranda, Steven R. (Pro Se)	Conservatorship Review - Biennial
Tentative Ruling: NO APPEARANCE The conservatorship shall continue and be reviewed in two (2) years. The assessment amount of \$850.00 for the cost of the court's investigation is ordered and deferred until the Court determines sufficient funds exist.		

21-PRO-00847	Conservatorship of Aaron L Chin	
Line 4	Proposed Conservatee: Chin, Aaron L Petitioner: Chin, Sandra (Pro Se) Proposed Conservator: Chin, Arthur L Proposed Conservator: Chin, Sandra Conservatee: Chin, Aaron L Conservator: Chin, Arthur L Conservator: Chin, Sandra	Conservatorship Review - Biennial
Tentative Ruling: NO APPEARANCE The conservatorship shall continue and be reviewed in two (2) years. The assessment amount of \$850.00 for the cost of the court's investigation is ordered and deferred until the Court determines sufficient funds exist.		



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23-PRO-00763	Conservatorship of Lisa Ann Sakaguchi	FIRST AND FINAL ACCOUNT AND REPORT OF CONSERVATORS; PETITION TO SETTLE ACCOUNT; TO FIX AND ALLOW CONSERVATOR AND ATTORNEYS' FEES AND COSTS; AND DISCHARGE CONSERVATOR
Line 5	Proposed Conservatee: Sakaguchi, Lisa Ann (DURRANS, KATHLEEN A.) Petitioner: Potts, Susan (URBATSCH, KEVIN P. JONES, JESSICA JENNIFER) Petitioner: Sakaguchi, Scott (URBATSCH, KEVIN P. JONES, JESSICA JENNIFER) Conservatee: Sakaguchi, Lisa Ann (DURRANS, KATHLEEN A.) Conservator: Potts, Susan Conservator: Sakaguchi, Scott	Petition Hearing

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

Petition is GRANTED with the following modifications:

Conservator Susan Potts' fees are granted in the amount of \$4,912.50, with reductions as follows: while Ms. Potts has relevant financial experience, she is not a licensed fiduciary, and the rate sought mirrors that of same. As such, the hourly rate is reduced to \$75.00. The total hours are reduced by 3 because it is unreasonable to charge four (4) hours for a Zoom court appearance on 3/15/2024, which was a very brief appearance.

The request for discharge is denied without prejudice, as an Ex Parte Petition for Final Discharge and Order (DE-295) is required.

The request for attorney's fees of \$30,146 is reduced by \$1,406 for what the Court sees as duplicative billing by paralegals/legal assistants. Additionally, items reflecting "OR" language, makes it unclear what exactly was done; moreover, for most of these charges there is no information provided as to why a paralegal would bill for a court appearance. As such, the award of attorneys' fees/costs is \$28,740.00.

The remainder of the First and Final Account and Report is GRANTED absent cogent objection.

Petitioner to submit final order with corresponds to this order.



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26-PRO-00370 26-PRO-0370-B	Estate of Howard Watts Williams	Removal, permanent appointment, bond, heirship, and any further relief Letters of Administration Hearing with ATA
Line 6 & 7	Petitioner: Jacobs, Bridgette (Pro Se) Petitioner: WALLACE, DARREN (ZOHAR, GADI) Decedent: Williams, Howard Watts Proposed Personal Representative: Jacobs, Bridgette	Petition Hearing

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

Absent cogent objection, the Court removes Bridgette Jacobs as Administrator of the Estate. The Court GRANTS the petition of Darren Wallace to Administer the Estate. Amended Letters should be secured and filed. Bridgette Jacobs to turn over immediately to Darren Wallace any estate property, records, financial information, account access, mail, keys, or other estate materials that she possesses or controls.



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26-PRO-00390	Estate of Armando Madrigal Barajas, JR	NOTICE OF MOTION AND MOTION TO CONSOLIDATE PETITION FOR PROBATE OF WILL AND FOR LETTERS OF ADMINISTRATION WITH WILL ANNEXED OF THE ESTATE OF ARMANDO MADRIGAL BARAJAS, JR. AND PETITION FOR LETTERS OF ADMINISTRATION OF THE ESTATE OF DENISE ALESSANDRA MADR
Line 8	Petitioner: Martinez, Kymberly (PATEL, KARISHMA) Petitioner: Veal, Morianton E (PATEL, KARISHMA) Decedent: Madrigal Barajas, Armando, JR Proposed Personal Representative: Martinez, Kymberly Proposed Personal Representative: Veal, Morianton E	Motion hearings

Tentative Ruling:

NO APPEARANCE

Motion to Consolidate is DENIED. There is no good cause for this request, and consolidating two separate estate administration matters in a single case would cause unnecessary complications and confusion. To say that the decedents died in the same incident, which is offered perhaps as a reason for consolidation, is interesting, in light of the fact that they died a few days apart,



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stemming from Decedent Armando Madrigal shooting and killing Decedent Denise Martinez, then shooting himself.

26-PRO-00431	Estate of William Zarubin	Continued from 07/13/26
Line 9	Petitioner: Zarubin, Steven (CRUZ, MICHELLE R. SHJEFLO, WALTER E.) Decedent: Zarubin, William Objector: Hayden, Joseph R. (LVOVICH, MILLA L.) Proposed Personal Representative: Zarubin, Steven	Probate of Will and Letters Testamentary Hearing w/ ATA

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

The Court has read the pleadings filed following the last appearance. The Court's position has not changed. Contrary to the suggestion in Mr. Shjeflo's reply filed 8/27/26, the Court did in fact read *"Attachment 3a(1), 3c, and 3g(3)" of the Amended Petition, starting at page 2 of the attachment.* It is not the declaration of Steven Zarubin which establishes that San Mateo County is the proper venue, but rather some admissible evidence by way of any declaration by the decedent which would establish he was domiciled in San Mateo County. Steven Zarubin's declaration contains inadmissible hearsay attributed to the decedent and then Steven Zarubin's belief concerning his father's intent. To repeat the tentative ruling of July 13, 2026, the Amended Petition, while it lists an address of property which the decedent potentially owned in San Mateo County, does not contain any additional facts or admissible evidence supporting the allegation that he was "domiciled" in San Mateo County. The decedent had been living in an assisted living facility in El Dorado County, and had lived in that county since February 2022. The Court continued this matter previously for petitioner to provide evidence establishing decedent's "intent to return" to San Mateo County, but no further evidence has been provided. Petitioner's recitation of applicable law on the issue is accurate, but doesn't not tip the Court's decision in his favor. There is no evidence, by way of act or declaration, that Decedent intended to return to San Mateo County. He moved to the county where his daughter resided, and then moved into an assisted living facility. As such,



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the proper venue for the administration of his estate is El Dorado County [where the will was lodged after his death in 2024]

26-PRO-00455	IN RE: THE LITA KRZYZANOWSKI TRUST ESTABLISHED AUGUST 7, 2025	PETITION TO CONFIRM TRUST OWNERSHIP OF ASSETS OF DECEDENT
Line 10	Petitioner: Krzyzanowski, LeAnn (RISWOLD, ERIN) Decedent: KRZYZANOWSKI, LITA MARIE	Petition to Confirm Trust Assets (Heggstad)

Tentative Ruling:

ARANCE OPTIONAL

Petition to Confirm Trust Ownership of Assets of Decedent is CONTINUED to December 1, 2026 at 9:00 am for Petitioner to file a proof of service/notice that complies with Probate Code 851 and uses Judicial Counsel form DE-115, and for petitioner to address why venue is proper in San Mateo County.

26-PRO-00461	IN RE THE LYLE & GEORGIA SHIFFER AB LIVING TRUST, DATED APRIL 17, 2004	PETITION FOR ORDER THAT ASSETS CONSTITUTE TRUST ASSETS
Line 11	Petitioner: Mills, Laura Shiffer (BRIDGES, MARK S.) Decedent: SHIFFER, GEORGIA LEE Decedent: SHIFFER, LYLE G, SR	Petition Hearing



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Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

Petition for Order that Assets Constitute Truste Assets is GRANTED absent cogent objection.

26-PRO-00462	Guardianship of Maria Maribel Otero Rodriguez	
Line 12, 13	Petitioner: Otero Rodriguez, Maria Maribel (BACHAN, ALEXANDRA) Ward: Otero Rodriguez, Maria Maribel Proposed Guardian: Otero Henriquez, Maria Barbara	Appointment of Guardian for Person of the Minor Petition for Special Immigrant Juvenile Findings

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE ORDERED (Zoom not allowed)

The court intends to GRANT both petitions.

26-PRO-00694	Estate of Paul Dean Parsons III	Continued from 07/06/26
Line 14	Petitioner: Delgado, Sharon Lee Ann (INGERSON, GREG M) Petitioner: Kidwell, Joseph Leo (INGERSON, GREG M) Decedent: Parsons III, Paul Dean	Letters of Administration Hearing with ATA

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

The court has read the documents filed since the last hearing, and accepts the scrivener's error in one of the attachments which identifies Decedent herein as "John Dean Parsons III." The Court has also received waivers of bond by the two intestate heirs. The Court is prepared to GRANT the

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petition for letters of administration, absent cogent objection . However, the Court makes no determination as to heirs, or what constitutes the estate of the Decedent, nor any effect or impact of the Mima Sanchez Parsons Living Trust, which seems to be suggested as relief sought in the supplemental filed August 31, 2026. Those issues would be the subject of further petitions if necessary. A formal order is required.

26-PRO-00793	Conservatorship of Babette Klase	Continued from 07/06/26
Line 15	Proposed Conservatee: Klase, Babette (GRUBER, JOSEPH E., JR) Petitioner: Klase, Andrew, IV (LEWIS, DOMENIC) Petitioner: Vasquez, Molly (LEWIS, DOMENIC) Proposed Conservator: Klase, Andrew, IV	Appointment of Temporary Conservator for Person and Estate
Tentative Ruling: APPEARANCE ORDERED (Zoom allowed) The Request to Appoint Temporary Conservator for the Person and Estate is GRANTED, absent cogent objection, and Letters shall expire on November 18, 2026, which is the date set on the petition for general conservatorship.		

26-PRO-00996	Estate of PAO YU LEE	
Line 16	Petitioner: LEE, YVONNE Y. (NG, LILLIAN E.) Decedent: LEE, PAO YU Proposed Personal Representative: LEE, YVONNE Y.	Letters of Administration Hearing with ATA
Tentative Ruling: NO APPEARANCE The Petition is GRANTED absent cogent objection		

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PRO052536	CONSERVATORSHIP OF VERNON GUTTMAN	SEVENTEENTH AND FINAL ACCOUNT, PETITION FOR TERMINATION OF CONSERVATORSHIP, FOR DISCHARGE OF SUCCESSOR LIMITED CONSERVATOR, AND WAIVER OF FEES
Line 17	Conservatee: GUTTMAN, VERNON Conservator: SAN MATEO CO PUBLIC GUARDIAN (SAN MATEO COUNTY ATTORNEY'S OFFICE) Payor: Payor	Petition Hearing
Tentative Ruling: NO APPEARANCE Seventeenth and Final Account is GRANTED absent cogent objection. Conservator will be discharged upon the granting of the Ex Parte Petition for Final Discharge.		

PRO126756	CONSERVATORSHIP OF GABRIEL A REYES	
Line 18	Petitioner: VELILLA, JOEL (PATEL, KARISHMA) Petitioner: VELILLA, ROSALINA (PATEL, KARISHMA) Conservatee: REYES, GABRIEL A Conservator: VELILLA, JOEL (PATEL, KARISHMA) Conservator: VELILLA, ROSALINA (PATEL, KARISHMA) Payor: Payor	Conservatorship Review - Biennial
Tentative Ruling: NO APPEARANCE Review Hearing is CONTINUED to <u>December 1, 2026 at 9:00 am</u> at the request of the court investigator.		

Hearings Total: 18